## Solar Power in India

Solar power is the conversion of energy from sunlight into electricity either directly using photovoltaic cells or indirectly using concentrated solar power. Solar panels absorb the sunlight as a source of energy to generate electricity. A solar electric system can reliably produce electricity for our home and offices. These distributed solar systems are often installed by home and business owners to reduce their electricity costs. Solar power in India is a fast-developing industry.

Tamil Nadu is the state with highest installed solar capacity in India. Tamil Nadu is one of the leading solar power producing states in India. As on 31 July 2017, the total installed capacity in Tamil Nadu is 1,697 MW.



## 1.5 Environmental Policies in India

Environmental policies in India have been evolved considerably over the past three decades. These policies have covered a wide range of issues such as air, water pollution, waste management and biodiversity conservation.

India faces challenges in economic development, which has to be achieved with limited resources, minimum externalities and in the presence of an uncertain climate. One of the approaches to overcome this challenge is through the path of sustainable development.

The Supreme Court of India has interpreted and introduced new changes in environmental protection through a series of directions and judgements.

Article 51A(g) of the Constitution states that "it shall be the duty of every citizen of India to protect and improve the natural environment including forests, lakes, rivers and wildlife and to have compassion for living creatures."

Development increases the quality of life. This means that people will have higher incomes, better education, better health and nutrition, less poverty and more equality of opportunity.

**List of Environmental Acts in India**

| S. No | Act | Action |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 | Environmental protection and conservation of forests and other natural resources |
| 2 | Biological Diversity Act, 2002 | To provide for conservation of biological diversity |
| 3 | The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 | Providing for the protection and improvement of the environment. |
| 4 | Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980 | Check deforestation and encourage afforestation of non-forest areas. |
| 5 | Water (Prevention and control of pollution) Act, 1974 | Provides maintenance and restoration and quality of all types of surface and groundwater. |
| 6 | Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 | Providing protection to wild animals and birds. |



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